Naming and service discovery

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Sample chapter for the proposed course plan.

1 Learning outcome

Separate a logical service name from a changing network address.

Prerequisites: Lectures 02–03.

2 Core idea

A logical service name lets callers refer to a service without embedding the address of a particular process. Discovery maps that name to an address. Cached mappings may become stale when processes move or stop.

3 Worked scenario

A client caches the address of the catalogue service. That instance is replaced before the cache entry expires.

4 Discussion

How should the client react when its cached address no longer works?

5 Recap

Naming hides location changes only when lookup and recovery behaviour are defined.